RAFAEL MORETTI-KLEIN

Principal Software Engineer | Engineering Leader
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal software engineer and engineering leader with 21 years of experience building large-scale backend systems in Python, Go and C++. Experienced in designing high-throughput services and APIs, leading platform engineering teams, and improving service reliability and operating costs. Led organisations of up to 45 engineers and defined architecture for platforms serving 50M+ users. Maintains a hands-on coding practice, writing code weekly, mostly on internal tooling in recent years.

CORE SKILLS

Backend development: Python (FastAPI, Flask, Django, Tornado, asyncio), Go, C++
Data and messaging: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Cassandra, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ
Cloud and infrastructure: GCP (GKE, Pub/Sub, BigQuery), AWS (EC2, S3), Kubernetes, Terraform
Engineering practices: Distributed systems design, API development, architecture reviews, observability (Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry), technical hiring, people management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform | Streamhaus GmbH, Munich *2019-Aug 2026*

- Led the platform organisation of 5 teams, 45 engineers and 5 engineering managers, responsible for identity, playback API, billing integration and developer platform.
- Led migration from a Python 2 monolith to approximately 60 Python and Go services on GKE; playback API availability improved from 99.5% to 99.95%.
- Reduced cloud spend by 31% (EUR 4.2M/year) through rightsizing, committed use discounts and an internal cost dashboard.
- Introduced an RFC process, architecture review board and on-call guidelines adopted company-wide.
- Grew the organisation from 18 to 45 engineers and conducted 200+ interviews.

Principal Engineer | Streamhaus GmbH *2015-2019*

- Served as technical lead for the playback API, using Python, Tornado and an internal framework similar to FastAPI, with Cassandra and Redis.
- Designed the entitlement service, handling 120k requests/second at peak using Go and Cassandra.
- Co-authored the company's service template and Python style guide.

Senior Software Engineer | Nordfels Telematik AG, Stuttgart *2010-2015*

- Built backend systems for fleet telematics, ingesting GPS data from 300k vehicles using C++ and Python, PostgreSQL/PostGIS and RabbitMQ.
- Led a team of 6 developers on the route-history product.

Software Engineer | Dataquelle Systems GmbH, Karlsruhe *2005-2010*

- Developed C++ and Python software for industrial data acquisition on Linux and embedded x86.
- Built a Python test harness used by QA for 8 years.

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Inf. (equivalent to MSc) in Computer Science | Rhine Valley University | 2005

PUBLICATIONS AND TALKS

“Running Python at 100k rps” | Conference talk | 2018
“Cost is a feature” | Internal platform engineering summit keynote | 2023

LANGUAGES

German (native), Italian (native), English (fluent)